

What you can ask Alexa

Every phrase below is live right now. Alexa was cleaned up on August 14 — she went from 69 things down to 33, and everything left on this card is something a person would actually say out loud.

THE PATTERN THAT ALWAYS WORKS

Anything on this card follows the same shape. If you forget a specific phrase, this one carries you.

"Alexa, turn on *[name]*"

Works for every routine, scene, zone and switch listed here — not just lights.

"Alexa, turn off *[name]*"

The reverse, wherever off means something.

If she says she can't find a device: say "Alexa, discover devices" and wait about thirty seconds. That's the fix for nearly every "I don't know that one" answer.

LIGHTS

Living room cans, on the new Kasa dimmer.

"Alexa, turn on Night Mode"

Drops the cans to 10% over a two-second fade — the level you set yourself.

"Alexa, turn off Night Mode"

Brings them back to full, same gentle fade.

"Alexa, turn on living room lights"

Full brightness, no fade.

"Alexa, set living room lights to 40 percent"

Any number you like. This is how you find a new level worth saving.

"Alexa, dim the living room lights"

Steps them down a notch from wherever they are.

Want a different night level? Set the cans where you like them by voice or on the wall dimmer, tell me, and I'll re-point Night Mode at it. Takes a minute.

TV

Fire TV in the viewing room, Apple TV in the bedroom.

"Alexa, turn on Skip the Commercials"

Jumps the Fire TV forward through a break.

"Alexa, turn on Resume Show"

Presses play again on the Fire TV.

"Alexa, turn on Sling"

Opens Sling TV on the Fire TV. "Sling TV" works too.

"Alexa, pause the Bedroom TV"

The Apple TV. "Play the Bedroom TV" starts it again.

AROUND THE HOUSE

"Alexa, turn on Good Night"

Turns off *every* light in the house and logs the time — including the new living room cans.

"Alexa, turn on Vacuum the House"

Sends Sharky out.

"Alexa, stop the Vacuum"

Sends him back.

IRRIGATION

The six B-Hyve zones, by plain number instead of their old codes.

"Alexa, turn on Zone One"

Front right. Two through Five follow the same pattern.

"Alexa, turn on Garden Zone"

The garden bed.

"Alexa, turn off Zone One"

Shuts it down.

Say turn off when you're done. A zone started by voice isn't running a scheduled program, so don't count on it stopping itself.

THE MERCEDES

"Alexa, turn on Car Heater"

The GLE's auxiliary heater.

"Alexa, turn on Car Climate"

Pre-entry climate control.

Remote *start* is deliberately not on Alexa — it needs the PIN and has Mercedes' own attempt limit behind it. That one stays in the app.

BACKYARD WEATHER

Your own weather station, not Alexa's guess at the region.

"Alexa, what's the Backyard Temperature?"

Straight off the station behind the house.

Humidity, wind and feels-like are all published to Alexa too, but she answers temperature questions far more reliably than the others. If one gives you trouble, the app always has it.

WHAT SHE CAN NO LONGER TOUCH

Thirty-six things were removed. Nothing you used is gone.

- **Nine Home Assistant add-ons** — Z-Wave, Studio Code Server, Plex, VLC, Spotify Connect, Traccar, the Silicon Labs flasher, the Blink liveview proxy, the CEC scanner. A stray "turn off Z-Wave" could have taken down real infrastructure.
- **Six camera motion-detection switches** — switching one off silently kills the alert pipeline, which is exactly how the cameras went quiet for four days earlier this month.
- **Four duplicate Tuya plugs** — Smart Life already hands Alexa the bed lamp, the water heater and two sockets. She was seeing each one twice. Smart Life's copies still work exactly as before.
- **Eleven Echo speakers handed back to Alexa** — she already owns her own speakers natively; these were noise in the device list.
- **Six odds and ends** — sun position, the home zone, the mower's last-sync text, and similar. Nothing anyone would say out loud.